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Dancing Along the In-Between: Folklore Performance and Transmigration in Portuguese Newark[1]

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Abstract: Revivalist folklore performance has figured prominently in the intensification of relations between transmigrants and the Portuguese state throughout the last twenty years. Both private and public institutions in Portugal strategize emigrant preservation of national customs as an essential tool for increasing Portugal's geopolitical visibility and fortifying ties with Portuguese emigrants. This essay argues that the existence of folklore groups ensures a constant traffic—of goods and services, performers and publics—between Portugal and emigrant communities in diaspora. Revivalist folklore is both a vehicle for the economic and emotional linking of emigrants to Portugal, and a tool for achieving what is termed "selective acculturation" within the United States. Luso-American folklore groups enact a curious paradox; they dedicate themselves to the preservation of distinctly Portuguese traditions and moral values abroad while simultaneously employing folklore performance as a strategy for assimilation in the form of civic participation within a US context. In constant dialogue between sending and receiving contexts, emigrant folklore performers both live and enact a transnationalism characterized by intense cultural, lingual and demographic plurality. © *2004 Portuguese Studies Review. All rights reserved.*

Introduction

Twentieth century Portugal has witnessed many governmental strategies for promoting nationalist ties among Lusophone communities in far flung continents. The *Estado Novo* (1926-74) of António Salazar drew a unifying rhetorical frame around distant colonies, defining them as interior to the body of the nation despite their severed geographic circumstance—Angola and Mozambique, for example, were not colonies but rather domestic appendages, "overseas *provincias*." This rhetorical formulation pointed not only to Salazar's imperialist ambitions, but also to the desire for an inclusive nation-state, one which viewed overseas **and** domestic citizens as working parts in the same rambling collective. Following World War II,

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the Portuguese state actively cultivated ties to Portuguese emigrants living in North America and Northern Europe. Emigrant remittances contributed greatly to the health of the Portuguese economy, particularly in times of great expenditure such as the colonial wars of the 1960s and 1970s.[2] Since the collapse of the *Estado Novo* dictatorship in 1974 and the dissolution of the colonial empire, Portuguese emigrant communities around the world have been the target of increased governmental attention and funding. Maria Baganha has suggested that the State simply transferred the object of its traditionally exterior focus from the overseas colonies to emigrants in diaspora.[3] Feldman-Bianco argues that this post-1974 shift points to a reconceptualizing of the nation as defined by people as opposed to places.[4]

Revivalist folklore performance figures prominently in the intensification of the relationship between emigrants and the Portuguese state in the late twentieth century. Both private and public institutions in Portugal strategize emigrant preservation of national customs throughout the world as an essential tool for increasing Portugal's geopolitical visibility and maintaining ties between Portuguese migrants and their native homeland. As I will argue in this essay, the existence of emigrant folklore groups called *ranchos folclóricos* ensures a constant traffic of goods and services, performers and the public, between Portugal and Portuguese communities in diaspora. Revivalist folklore is both a vehicle for the economic and emotional linking of emigrants to Portugal and a tool for achieving what Rumbaut and Portes term "selective acculturation" within the United States.[5]

Selective acculturation among immigrant groups, as Rumbaut and Portes define it, is marked by a "paced learning of the host culture along with retention of significant elements of the culture of origin."[6] In their extensive anthology analyzing

[2] Caroline Brettell, "The Immigrant, the Nation, and the State in Nineteenth and Twentieth-Century Portugal: An Anthropological Approach," *Portuguese Studies Review* 2 (2) (1993): 51-65; Caroline Brettell, *We Have Already Cried Many Tears: The Stories of Three Portuguese Migrant Women* (Prospect Heights, IL: Waveland Press, 1995); Caroline Brettell, *Anthropology and Migration: Essays on Transnationalism, Ethnicity and Identity* (Walnut Creek, CA: AltaMira Press, 2003).

[3] Maria Ioannis B. Baganha, "Keynote Address," given at the "Race, Culture, Nation: Arguments Across the Portuguese Speaking World," conference at Brown University and University of Massachusetts, Dartmouth (March 2001). This shift is also reflected in the official language used to describe new governmental departments after 1974.What used to be called the Secretary of the State of Emigration (*Secretaria do Estado da Emigração*) was changed to the Secretary of the State of Portuguese Communities (Overseas) (*Secretaria do Estado das Comunidades*). Bela Feldman-Bianco, "Multiple Layers of Time and Space: The Construction of Class, Ethnicity, and Nationalism among Portuguese Immigrants," in Nina Glick-Schiller *et. al.*, eds., *Towards a Transnational Perspective on Migration: Race, Class, Ethnicity and Naitonalism Reconsidered* (New York: The New York Academy of Sciences, 1992), 145-74.

[4] Feldman-Bianco, "Multiple Layers of Time and Space."

[5] Rubén G. Rumbaut and Alejandro Portes, "Introduction—Ethnogenesis: Coming of Age in Immigrant America," *Ethnicities: Children of Immigrants in America* (Berkeley: University of California Press, 2001), 1-19; Rubén G. Rumbaut and Alejandro Portes, "Conclusion: The Forging of a New America: Lessons for Theory and Policy," *Ethnicities: Children of Immigrants in America* (Berkeley: University of California Press 2001).

[6] Rumbaut and Portes, "Conclusion," 309.

the fourth wave experience of "segmented assimilation" across an array of US immigrant groups, scant mention is made of the role of expressive culture in processes of adaptation to new national contexts. I would argue, however, that in the Portuguese-American community of Northern New Jersey, selective acculturation cannot be understood without considering the way in which it is communicated and reinforced through performance.

Folklore performance supports both Portuguese and US em/immigration policies by invigorating Portuguese language use, moral values, and endogamy while simultaneously celebrating Luso-American commercial success and rising political visibility in New Jersey. Portuguese folklore performers enact a "back and forth" dynamic between Portugal and the US, where home and host society become "a single area of social action."[7] New Jersey folklore groups depend upon transnational media and transmigrants, "those who claim and are claimed by two or more nation states,"[8] for their survival. Many New Jersey *rancho* members return from Iberian holidays armed with costumes, video tapes of folklore performances and "gifts" of new songs and dances donated by childhood friends from hometown *ranchos*—the material with which groups in diaspora update and strengthen performance repertoires.[9]

New Jersey *ranchos folclóricos* dance along the transmigratory in-between, reinforcing core Portuguese values while performing ethnic traditions on American soil—an expression of difference accepted and often celebrated within the multicultural context of Newark NJ and its surrounding areas. Newark, a city which has struggled for decades to recover from the devastating effects of the 1967 race riots, has turned a history of racial strife into a platform for image-overhaul, where tropes of peacability between diverse ethnic groups form the foundation of a new post-riot identity. Newark's growing arts scene reflects this diversity, and the city's renaissance has been tied to the development of large scale arts infrastructure,[10] as well as the proliferation of smaller scale ethnic festivals and parades.[11] The annual Portugal Day parade and its display of *ranchos folclóricos* figures prominently in Newark's arts-driven revival. The fact that Portuguese folklore has been able to thrive in Newark and accompany Luso-American commercial success and political

[7] Maxine Margolis, *Little Brazil: An Ethnography of Brazilian Immigrants in New York City* (Princeton: Princeton University Press, 1994), 29.

[8] Nina Glick-Schiller, "Transmigrants and Nation-States; Something Old and Something New in the U.S. Experience," in Charles Hirschman, Philip Kasinitz, and Josh DeWind, eds., *Handbook of International Migration: The American Experience* (New York: Russell Sage, 1999), 96.

[9] Interview with Tony Cardoso, tape recorded by the author. Newark, New Jersey, 13 February 2003.

[10] Elizabeth Strom, "Converting Pork into Porcelain: Cultural Institutions and Downtown Development," *Urban Affairs Review* 38 (1) (2002), 3-28; Elizabeth Strom, "Cultural Policy as Development Policy: Evidence from the United States," *International Journal of Cultural Policy*, Forthcoming.

[11] Kimberly DaCosta Holton, "Post-Colonial Conflict and Community in a US Urban Enclave: Brazilian and Portuguese Immigrants in Newark, NJ," Paper presented at the Oral History Association Annual Meeting, Bethesda, Maryland (9 October 2003).

empowerment serves as a testament to Newark's post-riot transformation. *Ranchos* forward an image of Newark as a city that welcomes diversity and allows varied immigrant groups to maintain autochthonous traditions within Northern New Jersey's hearty regional embrace.

New Jersey folklore performance radiates out toward both sides of the Atlantic, imbricated simultaneously in processes of US adaptation and the maintenance of ties to Portugal. In constant dialogue between sending and receiving contexts, emigrant performers both live and enact transnationalism. This paper examines the struggles within the Portuguese community of Northern New Jersey over issues of assimilation, the state policies and pressures which catalyze selective acculturation's dynamic of national duality, and the ways in which folklore performance affirms and makes visible this transmigratory dialectic.

This article is based on three years of ethnographic fieldwork (2000-03) in the Portuguese-American communities of northern New Jersey. In addition to participant observation of numerous New Jersey *rancho* rehearsals and performances, I have conducted ethnographic interviews with folklore dancers, musicians, directors and festival organizers primarily from the '*Sonhos de Portugal*' *rancho* of Kearny, NJ and the '*Danças e Cantares de Portugal*' *rancho* of Elizabeth, NJ.[12] This article is also informed by research at the Rutgers-Newark archive of the Ironbound Oral History Project, a store of primary audio, visual and textual documents containing over 100 interview transcripts with Portuguese-speaking immigrants of Northern New Jersey[13] and the Newark archives of the *Luso-Americano* bi-weekly newspaper. Finally, this research into NJ folklore performance is consistently ghosted by my long term ethnographic investigation (1993-present) of *ranchos folclóricos* and political change in twentieth-century Portugal.[14]

[12] As is the case in Portugal, many New Jersey folklore performers move from *rancho* to *rancho* throughout the course of their performance careers. Reasons for leaving a *rancho* can include personality conflicts with fellow performers or *rancho* directors, a desire to join friends, spouses or other family members in a neighboring *rancho*, or geographical relocation. Several of the performers I interviewed had been members of other groups, including the *Rancho Folclórico* '*Roca-a-Norte*' of Newark, NJ, and the '*Rancho Folclórico de Barcuense*' of Newark, NJ, before joining their current *rancho*.

[13] The Rutgers-Newark Ironbound Oral History Project was founded by the author in 2001 as means to document the Portuguese-speaking population of Northern New Jersey, a community which has received little scholarly attention. To date, forty-seven student researchers have conducted and transcribed 124 Oral History Interviews with Portuguese speaking immigrants residing in northern New Jersey. These semi-structured interviews, typically one-to-two hours in duration, contain information as to the date and reasons for migration, strategies for adaptation, plans for return migration, expressive manifestations of ethnic and cultural identity in the US, conflict and collaboration within the Portuguese speaking community of Northern New Jersey, among other topics. The archive is in the process of being digitized for public access online (Rutgers University-Newark's Dana Library).

[14] See Kimberly DaCosta Holton, "Performing Social and Political Change: Revivalist Folklore Troupes in Twentieth Century Portugal," PhD Dissertation, Northwestern University (1999); Kimberly DaCosta Holton, "Fazer das tripas coração: o parentesco cultural nos ranchos folcóricos,"in Salwa El-Shawan Castelo Branco and Jorge Freitas Branco, eds., *Vozes do povo: a folclorização em Portugal*

Assimilation Debates

Folklore performance figures prominently in recent debates within the Portuguese community concerning the extent to which Luso-Americans should become integrated into mainstream US society and culture. The NJN documentary entitled *Ironbound: Ties to Portugal*[15] illustrates several vectors of this discourse, situating folklore performance on one side of what the film portrays as the assimilation/ anti-assimilation binary. Midway through the film, the camera focuses in on a large dinner table filled with *bacalhau* and *vinho verde*. Seated at the table in the midst of an intense debate are Newark New Jersey's Luso-American community leaders; Linda Rodrigues, a university professor, Armando Fontoura, Essex County Sheriff and Licínio Cruz, a local judge and co-owner of Cruz Construction Company. At issue is the move by some Portuguese families out of the Ironbound—Newark's "Little Portugal" neighborhood (see Figure 1):

> "Why do our people leave the Ironbound?" asks Professor Rodrigues (who still lives in the neighborhood).
> "For the American Dream," Sheriff Fontoura says with a smile.
> "And I don't have it?" Rodrigues asks in disbelief.
> "You have it. You left the Ironbound too, may I remind you, my dear. You went to graduate school ..."
> "But I came back," Rodrigues asserts, "My parents stayed here."
> "As soon as they could, my parents left," Judge Cruz says, "My father saw a better future for his family in the suburbs."
> "When Lee's father left, the Ironbound was still good," says Fontoura.
> "It's still good. It's still good, here, okay, Armando?" Rodrigues asserts over the rising din.
> "Look," Fontoura says, "let me ask you something. What's wrong with our people here in America—this is the melting pot—marrying within the American society, ours sons and daughters marrying Jewish Americans, Italian-Americans, Irish-Americans? That's the American way, that's what we do, that's the way it's supposed to be."[16]

The controversy continues as Luís Nogueira, then director of Newark's *Sport Clube Português*, wonders aloud if intermarriage will result in the loss of the Portuguese language and culture, causing Newark's Luso-Americans to be "phased out." As if in answer to anxiety over the dilution of Portuguese ethnicity, the film quickly cuts from the dinner table to a clip of an enormous feast sponsored by the *Sport Clube Português* in Newark. *Sardinhas* and *leitão* (sardines and suckling pig) rotate from large spits as hundreds of people gather at picnic tables, speaking in Portuguese. The camera pans from the barbecue to a heated soccer game where two

(Oeiras: Celta Editora, 2003), 143-52; Kimberly DaCosta Holton, *Revivalist Folklore Performance in Twentieth Century Portugal* (Bloomington: Indiana University Press, Forthcoming).

[15] *Ironbound Ties to Portugal*. New Jersey Network Video Documentary, 1999.

[16] *Ironbound Ties to Portugal*.

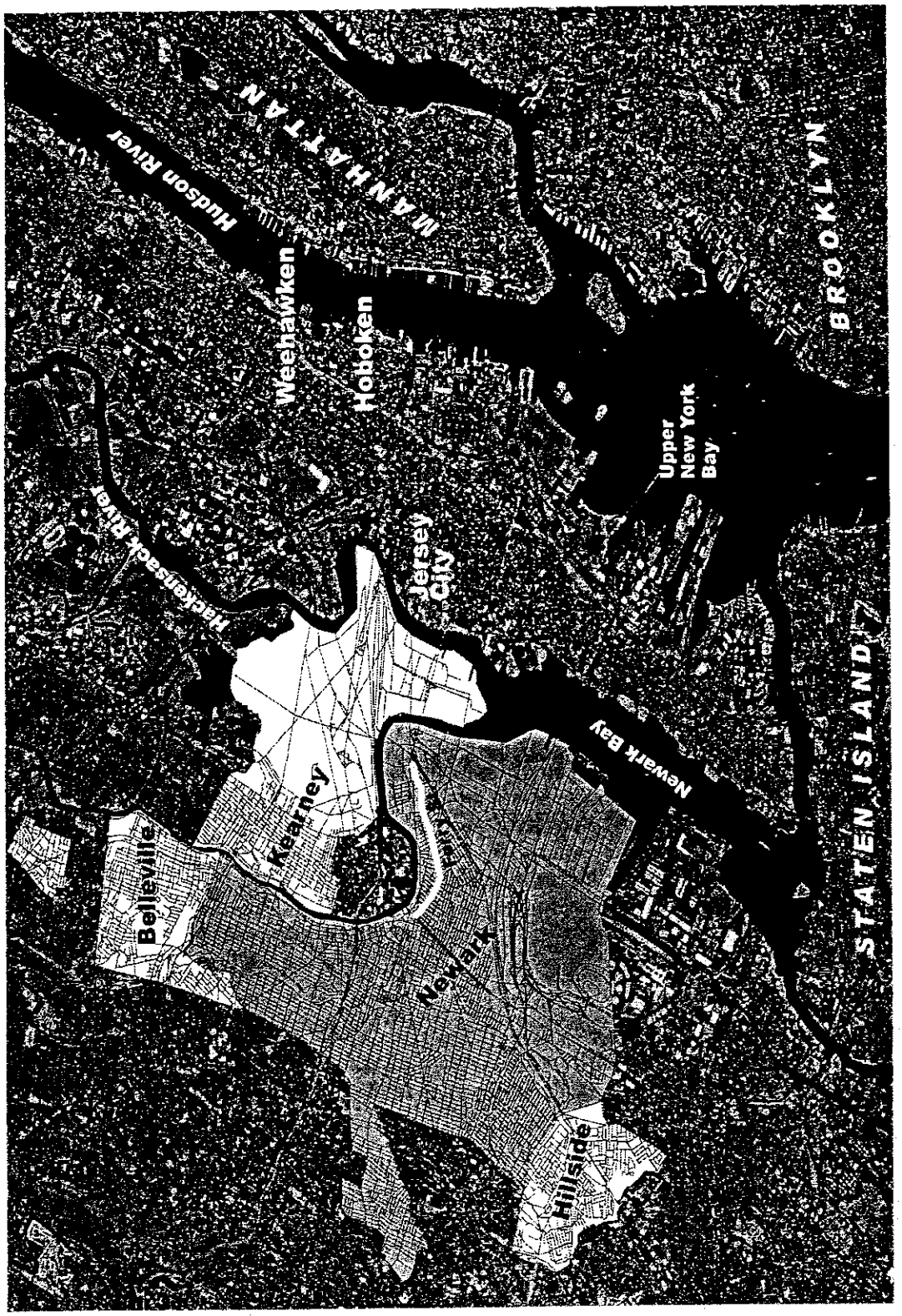

Figure 1. Map of Greater Newark and Surroundings

Note: Ferry Street, also known as "Portugal Avenue" marks the heart of the Ironbound. Neighboring towns of Kearny, Hillside and Belleville are also outposts of Portuguese immigration. Sources: U.S. Geological Survey, 1999/09/23, Landsat ETM+ Scene, WRS-2 Path 014 Row 032, Level: Orthorectified (sourced through Global Land Cover Facility, University of Maryland) (contrast stretching and detail processing: Martin M. Elbl [PSR]); US Census Bureau, TIGER Line 2002 (overlay extraction: Martin M. Elbl).

players are arguing over a foul the referee never called. Then the camera switches to a folklore performance going on beside the barbecue where a large, well-rehearsed *rancho folclórico* begins a whirling dance for a cheering public. This segment of the film ends with the *Sport Clube* director speaking into the camera.

> We put everything together in one event, we play soccer, dance folklore, we do the barbecue ... For a change, we have a different kind of unity. A lot of people remember the feasts and the parties from back home in Portugal ... It's in our blood, it's part of our culture.[17]

The crisis point I describe not only involves tension over demographic changes within the Portuguese enclave in the Ironbound, but also over the more generalized process of assimilation and its effects on ethnic identity, solidarity and sociability. In the film, the expressive markers of Portuguese ethnicity—soccer, religious devotion to Fátima, *fado* and folklore—are all spliced together in an amalgamated portrayal of ethnic purity, anathema to Sheriff Fontura and others' call for assimilation. From the perspective of the film's producers, performing folklore is a means to fight *against* integration and ethnic dissolution. As I will argue in the last section of this paper, the reality of folklore's role with regard to assimilation is more nuanced and dialectical, contributing to both sides of the film's binary formulation.

Assimilation has been a hot topic of debate among anthropologists and sociologists who study America's post-1965 fourth wave of emigration—widely acknowledged as the United States' most profound demographic transformation in a century.[18] Traditional Chicago School models of linear assimilation, which theorize the seamless loss or absorption of ethnicity into white mainstream society over the course of three generations of socio-economic ascent, have recently been challenged by scholars who present a more complex and varied portrait of ethnic adaptation.[19] Rumbaut and Portes argue that the second generation of fourth wave migrants undergoes what they term "segmented assimilation" where "outcomes vary across immigrant minorities" and where "rapid integration and acceptance into the

Figure 1. Map of Greater Newark and Surroundings

Note: Ferry Street, also known as "Portugal Avenue" marks the heart of the Ironbound. Neighboring towns of Kearny, Hillside and Belleville are also outposts of Portuguese immigration. **Sources:** U.S. Geological Survey, 1999/09/23, Landsat ETM+ Scene, WRS-2 Path 014 Row 032, Level: Orthorectified (sourced through Global Land Cover Facility, University of Maryland) (contrast stretching and detail processing: Martin M. Elbl [PSR]); US Census Bureau, TIGER Line 2002 (overlay extraction: Martin M. Elbl).

[17] *Ironbound Ties to Portugal.*

[18] Rumbaut and Portes, "Introduction," 7; Rumbaut and Portes argue that today's era of mass immigration—"now overwhelmingly non-European in composition ... [raises] serious questions about the applicability of explanatory models developed in connection with the experience of European ethnics [earlier in this century]" (Rumbaut and Portes, "Introduction," 5). It is evident here that Rumbaut and Portes view European migration as a phenomenon of the past. That is not, however, the case with Portuguese migration to the US—particularly to the state of New Jersey—which saw a surge in the 1960s and 1970s, due to a variety of factors from the colonial wars and political instability in Portugal to the US repeal of the quota system in 1964. The Portuguese have been called an "invisible minority" in the US, due to low levels of civic engagement and political participation. The Portuguese remain an invisible minority, I would argue, also due to scholarly inattention to these communities. In a modest attempt towards visibility, this chapter examines Portuguese immigrant communities as part and parcel of the fourth wave migration to the US.

[19] Rumbaut and Portes, "Introduction"; Rumbaut and Portes, "Conclusion."

American mainstream represent just one possible alternative."[20] Based on studies of thousands of second generation immigrants from diverse ethnicities, Rumbaut and Portes describe the varying coordinates along the trajectory ranging from complete assimilation to oppositional ethnic plurality.

The Portuguese immigrant community of Northern New Jersey, I would argue, falls in the middle of this trajectory, practicing a form of "selective acculturation," "commonly associated with fluent bilingualism in the second generation ... [and] absorption by second generation youths of key values and normative expectations from their original culture and concomitant respect for them."[21] The measures of ethnic assimilation employed by Rumbaut and Portes center on issues of bilingualism, patterns of sociability and the dynamics of co-ethnic communities.

In the case of Portuguese Newark, what specific factors have shaped the dynamic of selective acculturation? I would argue that in addition to factors such as a condensed urban settlement pattern,[22] and a tightly-knit, relatively homogenous co-ethnic community, State policies on im/emigration have also contributed greatly to the way in which the Luso-American community of Northern New Jersey integrated into mainstream American society while retaining key values of the country of origin.

State Policies, Language Use and Selective Acculturation

As Bela Feldman-Bianco argues, Luso-American immigrants have experienced shifting pressures from both the US and Portuguese governments with regard to assimilation.[23] In the 1920s and 1930s Portuguese migrants "were subjected to restrictive immigration laws and second class citizen status in both the United States and Portugal."[24] Conflicting national ideologies also left immigrants torn: the U.S. "melting pot" formulation guided immigrants into an ideal of swift and total assimilation versus a doctrine of racial superiority proffered by the Portuguese government, which encouraged the "exclusive maintenance of Portuguese culture and language."[25]

[20] Rumbaut and Portes, "Introduction," 6.

[21] Rumbaut and Portes, "Conclusion," 309.

[22] For an excellent study on the settlement patterns and social dynamics of the Portuguese Canadian community, see Carlos Teixeira, *Portugueses em Toronto: uma comunidade em mudança* (Açores: Direcção Regional das Comunidades, 1999).

[23] Feldman-Bianco, "Multiple Layers of Space and Time."

[24] Feldman-Bianco, "Multiple Layers of Space and Time," 146.

[25] Feldman-Bianco, "Multiple Layers of Space and Time," 146; Feldman-Bianco argues that during the 1920s and 1930s the Portuguese state viewed emigrants as "second class citizens" and traitors to their country for having left. Other scholars document widespread social stigmatization of Portuguese emigrants upon returning home throughout the twentieth century; Brettell, *Anthropology and Migration*; Sally Cole, *Women of the Praia: Work and Lives in a Portuguese Coastal Community* (Princeton: Princeton University Press, 1991). Although the economic success of the emigrants in mid- to late-twentieth century made the State dependent on the remittances of the Portuguese abroad, this symbiosis did little to lessen the migrants difficult reentry into Portugal for holidays or retirement; "they

Since the 1970s, however, both countries changed their official stance *vis-à-vis* Portuguese migration. The US repealed the 1924 National Origins Quota Act in 1965, dissolving strict limitations on emigration according to country of origin. Cultural pluralism, an ideology which encouraged the maintenance of diverse ethnic traditions and values within the North American polity came to dominate the US approach. This ideology also dominates Newark's city government rhetoric today. In describing Newark's ongoing revitalization, Mayor Sharpe James states, for example, "Our greatest strength lies not in bricks and mortar, but in our rainbow of peoples and cultures whose diversity and energy have fueled our rebirth and growth. Sample our restaurants, visit our cultural attractions, meet our diverse people."[26] The Portuguese Ironbound section of the city is often singled out for its active participation in Newark's post-riot recovery.[27] Boasting low crime rates, carefully maintained residential buildings and a booming commercial district replete with ethnic restaurants and shops, the Ironbound's "Little Portugal" figures prominently in Newark's narrative of urban renewal and multicultural acceptance.[28]

The post-colonial Portuguese State also enlarged its concept of nation in recent decades to include Portuguese emigrants around the globe. Portugal passed a law in 1981 permitting dual nationality and allowing Portuguese emigrants who had lost their native citizenship to regain it. As Irene Bloemraad points out, nowadays it is almost impossible for a Portuguese emigrant to claim singular non-Portuguese citizenship: "If a Portuguese swears the [US] oath of allegiance today, the state of Portugal will continue to consider that person a Portuguese national. Many immigrants therefore find themselves in a situation of *de facto* dual citizenship."[29] The change in both US and Portuguese ideology toward Portuguese emigrants residing in the US set up the conditions for selective acculturation. It is in the interest of both states, according to current policies, for Portuguese-Americans to recognize an allegiance both to the sending and receiving contexts.

The Portuguese government has not confined its overseas focus solely to issues of emigrant citizenship. In 1996, it also created a special consultative council, the *Conselho das Comunidades Portuguesas—CCP* (Council for Portuguese

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are still pejoratively called 'French', 'Canadian', 'Brazilians', 'Americans'" (Feldman-Bianco, "Multiple Layers of Time and Space," 150).

[26] Sharpe James, "Welcome Statement," The Official Website of the City, Newark, NJ, www.ci.newark.nj.us (2004).

[27] Sharpe James, "Keynote Address," *'Os Lusíadas'* Portuguese American Student Group of Rutgers University Newark Annual Awards Dinner, Newark, NJ (March 2002).

[28] Jean Rae-Turner and Richard T. Koles, *Newark New Jersey* (Charleston, SC: Arcadia, 2001) 153-54; Paul S. Grogan and Tony Proscio, *Comeback Cities: A Blueprint for Urban Neighborhood Revival* (Boulder, CO: Westview Press, 2001), 137-38. For more on the history of Newark and the evolution of the Ironbound section, see Rae-Turner and Koles and John T. Cunningham, *Newark* (Newark, NJ: New Jersey Historical Society, 1988).

[29] Irene Bloemraad, "The North American Naturalization Gap: An Institutional Approach to Citizenship Acquisition in the United States and Canada," *International Migration Review* 36 (1): 205 [my parenthesis].

Communities), comprised of 100 elected representatives from varying international hubs of Portuguese emigration who gather regularly to communicate their concerns directly to Lisbon.[30] The Portuguese government also began giving increased cultural support to Portuguese in diaspora following the revolution of 1974 that ended colonialism. In several well-publicized visits to Newark in the 1990s, for example, Portugal's Prime Minister António Guterres and Secretary of the Portuguese Communities, José Lello, gave speeches suggesting that the immigrant community both maintain Portuguese customs and traditional values abroad, while simultaneously committing to their current geographical locale through increased assimilation, US citizenship procurement and political participation. Former Prime Minister Guterres spoke at the inauguration of the new Portuguese Consulate of Newark in 1998 promising, "We [the Portuguese government] will do our best to be present here, but you [Luso-Americans] must strongly participate in the civic and political life of the United States."[31] Five years later, the Minister of Foreign Commerce and Portuguese Communities, António Martins da Cruz, reiterated this very same message in a 2003 address to Luso-Americans in Danbury, Connecticut. Reporting on the event, Henrique Mano writes, "Martins da Cruz asked the Portuguese to integrate themselves into their adopted homeland, but also encouraged them to keep the umbilical cord tied to their country of origin."[32] Cruz elaborates by suggesting that

> ... the best way not to forget Portugal is to teach your children and grandchildren, the new generation, Portuguese culture and language. The best way to keep the nation of Portugal always present here is to speak Portuguese, to have *ranchos folclóricos*, and to have groups which prolong our culture here.[33]

In this statement, Martins da Cruz identifies folklore performance as an important vehicle for conjuring the nation of Portugal on American soil and keeping Portuguese culture alive while integrating into US society.

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[30] There is a feeling among many CCP representatives that the Portuguese government has not used the emigrant think-tank to its fullest potential. Hoping to augment the visibility and political influence of Portuguese communities in diaspora, select CCP members have even proposed the creation of the *Partido do Emigrant* (Emigrant Party) in order to secure elected seats for emigrants in the Portuguese Parliament. See for example, Fernando Santos, "A prática do Conselho das Communidades passará sempre pela capacidade de afirmação dos seus membros," *Luso-Americano* (25 Sept. 2002): 2-3 and "Conselho das Comunidades Portuguesas: reunião amanhã e sexta-feira em Mass. Prepara plenário de 26 a 28 de Junho," *Luso-Americano* (June 4, 2003): 4. For more on CCP's history, see "Com onze tarefas para cumprir: Conselho das Comunidades Portuguesas reune em Lisboa de 8 a 13 de setembro," *Luso-Americano* (1997).

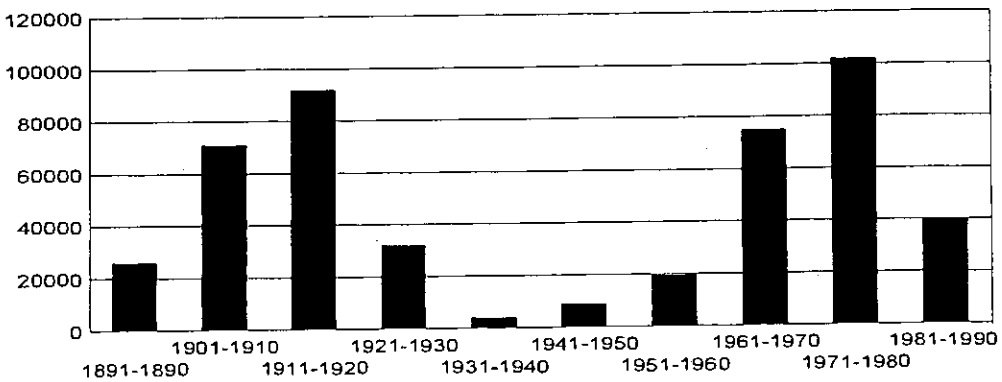
[31] *Ironbound Ties to Portugal.*

[32] Henrique Mano, "Martins da Cruz defende consulados itinerantes," *Luso-Americano* (24 September 2003): 8. Unless otherwise noted, all translations are my own.

[33] Mano, "Martins da Cruz," 8.

This official stance urging immigrants both to stay connected to Portuguese culture and to become assimilated agents in their adopted homeland is accompanied by an aggressive campaign by the *Instituto Camões* to solidify Portuguese language acquisition in emigrant communities abroad—particularly among second and third generation immigrants. The *Instituto Camões* plan, which involves supporting community language schools, university Portuguese Studies programs and the founding of Portuguese Language Centers around the globe, aims to increase the number of Portuguese speakers throughout the world, so that Portuguese, currently the sixth most spoken international language can become a vital communicative vehicle in the world of business, international trade and foreign relations. According to this plan, immigrant communities act as both linguistic incubators of future Portuguese language vitality and intermediaries between Portugal and the immigrants' newly adopted homelands.[34]

Figure 2. Portuguese Emigration to the United States by Decade (1891-1990)



Source: Immigration and Naturalization Service, Department of Justice, 1997. Adapted from António Luís Vicente, *Os Portugueses nos Estados Unidos: política de comunidades e comunidade política*. Lisbon: Fundação LusoAmericana Para o Desenvolvimento, 1999.

The change in US and Portuguese policy toward im/emigrants occurs concomitantly with a surge in Portuguese migration to the US. Emigration from Portugal to the US rose dramatically between 1965-80 (see Figure 2) due to a variety of exogenous and endogenous factors, including economic hardship, political instability and colonial war in Portugal, the US repeal of the 1924 National

[34] The US immigrant communities are particularly important elements in this plan because unlike Portuguese communities in France and Germany, whose migratory leavetaking is consistently framed as "temporary," (see Andrea Klimt, "Temporary and Permanent Lives: The Construction of Identity Among Portuguese Migrants in Germany," PhD Dissertation, Stanford University [1992]); Portuguese immigrants in the US tend to reside permanently in their host country. For a comparative analysis of European state involvement among their emigrant populations, see António Luís Vicente, *Os Portugueses nos Estados Unidos: política de comunidades e comunidade política* (Lisbon: Fundação LusoAmericana Para o Desenvolvimento, 1999), 61-66.

Origins Quota Act in 1965, and a softening of the 1974 Northern European labor market which resulted in the redirection of Portuguese emigrants previously destined for France, Germany and Belgium.[35]

Figure 3. Number of Luso-Americans and Portuguese Language Use by State, 1990

	General Population	Luso-American Pop.	Port. Lang. Use*
California	29,760,021	275,492	78,232
Massachusetts	6,016,425	241,173	133,373
Rhode Island	1,003,464	76,773	39,947
New Jersey	7,730,188	56,928	55,285
Hawaii	1,108,229	39,748	1,110

Source: 1990 US Census of Population, Detailed Population Characteristics, adapted from Vicente. *Os Portugueses nos Estados Unidos.*

* This category indicates the number of Luso-Americans who still speak Portuguese at home.

Figure 4. Citizenship and Year of Immigration for New Jersey's Foreign-Born Persons by Country of Birth: 1980

Place of Origin	Foreign-Born Population of NJ	1975-1980	1970-1974	1965-1969	1960-1964	1950-1959	Before 1950
Azores	219	15	84	50	16	25	29
Continental Portugal	28,234	7,520	9,788	6,021	1,886	1,126	1,893

Source: 1980 US Census of Population, Detailed Population Characteristics.

During the period between 1960 and 1980, many Portuguese bound for the US settled in New Jersey. According to the 1990 Census, New Jersey boasts the fourth largest population of Portuguese, behind California, Massachusetts, and Rhode Island, in that order (see Figure 3). New Jersey is distinguished by having the highest proportion of continental Portuguese and an extremely high concentration of recently arrived Portuguese emigrants (see Figure 4). Upon analyzing the 1980 Census numbers for New Jersey, we can see that 83 per cent of the population of

[35] Maria Baganha and Pedro Góis argue that Northern Europe basically reversed its "open door" policy with regard to emigrant laborers in the mid-1970s "promoting the integration of previously-arrived immigrants while discouraging the arrival of new emigrant labor. In other words—permitting family reunification and prohibiting economic emigration." Maria I. Baganha and Pedro Góis, "Migrações internacionais de e para Portugal: o que sabemos e para onde vamos," *Revista Crítica de Ciências Sociais* 52/53 (November 1998/February 1999): 235.

foreign-born Portuguese arrived between 1965 and 1980.[36] Another indicator of New Jersey's relatively newly arrived Portuguese population is the large percentage of Portuguese families who speak Portuguese in the home. According to the 1990 US Census data illustrated in Figure 3, out of a population of 56,928 Portuguese in New Jersey (first ascendancy only) 55,285 people aged five or older speak Portuguese in the home.[37] A much greater proportion of New Jersey Luso-Americans have thus retained native language use relative to the Portuguese communities in Massachusetts, Rhode Island and California—native language use, of course, being an essential component of selective acculturation.

The cultural and lingual vibrancy of Northern New Jersey's Portuguese population is also evident in the built environment. Throughout Newark's East Ward Ironbound section, and interspersed throughout the downtown areas of neighboring towns of Elizabeth, Kearny, Hillside, Perth Amboy and Bellville, Portuguese-owned businesses announce themselves through bilingual signs, often incorporating the colors of the Portuguese flag and other emblems of national identity such as the sixteenth-century caravel and the one-eyed portrait of Luís de Camões. Many apartment buildings in these areas feature ceramic tiles of Fátima and the three shepherd children, red clay roofs, elaborate urban gardens of fig trees and grape arbors, and mosaic stone sidewalks reminiscent of urban Portugal. In the business districts of Newark, Kearny and Elizabeth, many retail shops, banks, and professional offices post signs announcing "*Fala-se Português*" ("Portuguese Spoken Here"). The local ATM machines have a Portuguese language option and the Portuguese community has its own Lusophone yellow pages.

The concentration of Portuguese residents in Newark—the city's largest ethnic group according to the 1990 census[38]—has allowed a staggering number of Portuguese businesses to flourish.[39] This robust commercial presence has a double

[36] Of course, the numbers in Figures 2, 3, and 4 do not include the large proportion of emigrants who left the country clandestinely and settled in the US as undocumented aliens. Although there have been no systematic studies of undocumented Portuguese emigrants, Maria Baganha has estimated, for example, that illegal emigration to France and Germany between 1950 and 1988 comprised at least 36 per cent of total emigration to those countries. See Maria Ioannis B. Baganha, "Portuguese Emigration After World War II," in António Costa Pinto, ed., *Modern Portugal* (Palo Alto, CA: Society for the Promotion of Science and Scholarship, 1998), 192. If we extrapolate to a US context, adding data from the Ironbound Oral History Project where close to half of the interviewees arrived in New Jersey illegally, it is clear that these official numbers do not accurately quantify the number of Portuguese living in the region.

[37] Vicente, *Os Portugueses nos Estados Unidos*, 61-66.

[38] Vicente, *Os Portugueses nos Estados Unidos*.

[39] Mario do Carmo Pereira has conducted an exhaustive study on the history of Portuguese business and commerce in Northern New Jersey. According to her research, during the 1970s, 360 new Portuguese businesses were created, among them 56 restaurants, 37 construction companies, 40 automobile service station and 12 import/export retail establishments. From 1981 to 1990 there was close to double the number of new Portuguese businesses established. Out of 691, 148 were construction companies, 44 automobile service stations, 30 restaurants and 18 travel agencies. See Maria do Carmo Pereira, "Segundo caderno: um século de actividade comercial portuguesa em Newark,

effect of serving the monolingual foreign-born population while obligating the second and third generation Luso-Americans and ethnic outsiders to become conversant in the language/culture in order to navigate the area as consumers and fellow merchants. This in turn feeds the educational programs funded by the *Instituto Camões* by populating them with students who feel they must know Portuguese to break into the Northern New Jersey job market. The multi-contextual and quotidian use of Portuguese in Northern New Jersey, as a language of commerce, religion, and domestic life, has created a structure of mutually reinforcing linguistic joists which facilitate the maintenance of the language into the second and third generation. This feature of New Jersey's Portuguese community is directly attributable to both state policies and ideologies with regard to the late twentieth century emigration.

In conclusion, the post-1974 Portuguese government has asserted a two-pronged policy of cultural preservation and US assimilation, while the US has welcomed Portuguese emigrants by repealing the 1924 National Origins Quota Act in 1965, and forwarding a post-civil-rights-era agenda of multiculturalism.[40] These state ideologies create a hospitable environment for the "retention of significant elements of the culture of origin," "fluent bilingualism in the second generation" and the perseverance of "key values and normative expectations from the original culture"—the primary components of selective acculturation, according to Rumbaut and Portes' definition. The ethos of transnational hybridity is reflected in the built environment of Northern New Jersey and the large quantity of Portuguese-owned businesses that thrive throughout the region. The transmigratory dynamic of living between two national contexts, where the home and host society commingle in a "single arena of social action" is also facilitated by the predominance of newly arrived emigrants within the community, the high density of Portuguese in Northern New Jersey, and their settlement in self-contained urban enclaves.[41]

Dancing Along the In-Between

Portuguese emigrants in northern New Jersey gain social and cultural capital by "keeping their feet" in two national contexts. The adroit navigation between Portugal and the US has resulted in commercial success and political empowerment within New Jersey's Portuguese community, which, in turn, requires making visible

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New Jersey," *Luso-Americano* (7 June 1996): 52-9.

[40] Obviously, the extent to which the US is a hospitable receiving context depends not only on the historical moment, but also varies according to country of origin. These variances are fully explored in Rumbaut and Portes, *Ethnicities*. The attacks of September 11 and the legislation these events provoked, of course, also mitigate the ideology of multicultural pluralism, sparking a new and yet unfolding phase in the United States' approach to immigration.

[41] Another factor which contributes to the dynamic of selective acculturation is the tightly-knit, co-ethnic community of the Ironbound which has a history of intense intergroup support and assistance. New Jersey's population is overwhelmingly continental with a strong regional orientation toward the North of Portugal.

one's commitment to both originary and adopted homelands. This is where revivalist folklore performance becomes a vital part of transmigration, imbricated as it is in the commercial and political life of Northern New Jersey's Portuguese community and in national emigration ideologies.

Within Northern New Jersey's Luso-American community, selective acculturation must be examined alongside performative manifestations of ethnic identity. Folklore performance is consistently present in debates over Portuguese assimilation. Remember the Connecticut speech, where Foreign Commerce Minister Martins da Cruz singles out *ranchos folclóricos* in his appeal to Luso-Americans to "keep the umbilical cord tied to Portugal" while integrating into the US. Revivalist folklore performance invigorates Portuguese language use, moral values, and endogamy while celebrating Luso-American commercial success and political ascendancy. Folklore groups depend upon transmigrants and transnational media for the creation and periodic renewal of their performance repertoire and costumes, the restoration of musical instruments and historical props, the recruitment of performers and publics and the exchange of ideas and advice among folklore groups throughout the Portuguese diaspora. Northern New Jersey's thriving folklore scene is both an expressive symbol of and practical means towards the achievement of selective acculturation.

Rancho performance in diaspora differs greatly from *rancho* performance within the bounded space of Portugal. Portuguese *ranchos* have fought a social stigma due to folklore's association with the fascist regime that controlled Portugal from 1926 to 1974. Following the 1974 revolution that ended fascism, Portuguese *ranchos* overhauled costumes, musical repertoire and choreography to rid folklore of its ties to fascist cultural policy. Shedding fascist spectacle that had turned folklore dancers into whirling national flags, reformed *ranchos* now meticulously research turn-of-the-century tradition using ethnographic methodologies. Reformed *ranchos* perform historically reconstructed dances drawn from the locality in which performers live. Revivalist folklore in Portugal today combines scholarship with performative expression.[42]

The hundreds of *ranchos folclóricos* that exist in Portuguese immigrant communities of Northern Europe, Brazil, South Africa, Southeast Asia, Canada and the US, however, have not for the most part experienced fascist stigma nor undergone post-revolutionary cultural reform. *Ranchos* in the diaspora generally do not conduct ethnographic research but rather recreate dances from books, videos, television programs or in consultation with other folklore groups in Portugal. Some perform the nation, **not** the locality, using amalgamated costumes and repertoire sampled from all of Portugal's twelve regions, as is the case in Hamburg, Germany.[43] Other *ranchos* combine Portuguese folklore with performance traditions

[42] Holton, "Performing Social and Political Change."

[43] Klimt, "Temporary and Permanent Lives"; Andrea Klimt, "Enacting National Selves: Authenticity, Adventure, and Disaffection in the Portuguese Diaspora," *Identities* 6 (2000): 513-550.

from their current cultural environment, as is the case in Malaysia's Portuguese Settlement.[44] Still other *ranchos* select one region to represent, as is the case with many *ranchos* in New Jersey, and this region, Minho, acts as a synecdoche for the nation.[45] Although at first glance they appear similar to Portugal's fascist troupes of the 1950s in their patriotic celebration of the nation, *ranchos* in diaspora construct "Portuguese" identities to further differing political and social ends.

There are currently twelve active *ranchos* in northern New Jersey.[46] New Jersey *ranchos*, like their Portuguese counterparts, are comprised of amateur musicians and dancers who perform reconstructions of traditional songs and dances from the late nineteenth century. Typically composed of 30-35 members, New Jersey *ranchos folclóricos* feature 8-10 pairs of dancers, a section of instrumentalists called the *tocata* and several vocalists. The dancers are typically the youngest members of the group, ranging in age from five to thirty years. The musicians, usually older men in their forties and fifties, play instruments such as the accordion, concertina, clarinet and various forms of guitars and percussion, depending on the regional repertoire. The vocalists perform alone or in pairs. *Ranchos*, both in Portugal and the United States, often operate under the auspices of larger cultural associations or social organizations.

Ranchos typically rehearse weekly throughout the fall and winter and perform regularly during the spring and summer months at festivals and religious and civic celebrations. *Ranchos folclóricos* are often hired to mark the observance of both American and Portuguese holidays, such as *São Martinho*, *25 de Abril*, Fátima celebrations, Father's Day, Mother's Day, and the Fourth of July. Many New Jersey *ranchos* also perform in secondary schools throughout the state, at Newark colleges and universities, and in International Folklore Festivals throughout the US. New Jersey *ranchos* occasionally travel to Portugal to perform or to other Portuguese emigrant communities in Europe, South Africa and the Americas. The primary focus of the New Jersey *rancho* performance calendar, however, is Newark's enormous Portugal Day festival which takes place during the week of June 10. Most *ranchos* appear in the cacophonous weekend parade alongside their own floats, while also performing in other festival programming throughout the week.

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[44] Margaret Sarkissian, *D'Albuquerque's Children: Performing Tradition in Malaysia's Portuguese Settlement* (Chicago: University of Chicago Press, 2000).

[45] The vast majority of New Jersey *ranchos* identify themselves with the Northern province of Minho. In his 1995 article "Minho: retrato oitocentista de uma paisagem de eleição," António Medeiros argues that, beginning in the last half of the nineteenth century, the region of Minho is imbued with mythical characteristics of primordialism, acting as a synechdoche for the nation and regional repository of national memory. See António.Medeiros, "Minho: retrato oitocentista de uma paisagem de eleição," *Revista Lusitânia*, Nova Série (1995): 13-14, 97-123.

[46] These *ranchos* include "Eira," "Roca-o-Norte," "Aldeia Velha," "Camponêses do Minho," "Rancho Folclórico da Casa do Minho," "Rancho Cantares do Norte Newark," "Danças e Cantares de Elizabeth," "Os Sonhos Continuam," "Sonhos de Portugal," and "Barcuense."

One of the ways in which Northern New Jersey's community of 72,196 Portuguese immigrants[47] maintains transnational links between Portugal and the US is through what Appadurai calls "global mediascapes."[48] Folklore dancing is just one expression of globalized associationism that ties in to other media-driven activities such as reading the Portuguese immigrant newspaper, watching the international Portuguese cable channel, and listening to Portuguese radio programs. This Lusophone mediascape not only furthers the goals of the *Instituto Camões*' linguistic ambitions, it also creates "communities of sentiment" where through the collective cultural consumption of videos, TV, audio cassettes and newspapers, "groups of people begin to think and feel things together."[49] Through Lusophone mediascapes, *ranchos folclóricos* maintain contact with their homeland and with other Portuguese immigrant communities around the globe. This mediascape becomes an essential tool for both *rancho* repertoire building and *rancho* promotion; immigrant *ranchos* learn new songs and dances from watching TV, and gain visibility from appearing on Portuguese cable. Folklore performance, as it exists within a well-developed system of cultural consumption and reproduction, is an ideal vehicle for maintaining ties to Portugal and the Portuguese diaspora, while asserting a political and cultural voice in the US—the twin goals of Portuguese state policy after 1974.

Virtual travel between Portugal and the US is also complemented by real trips home. Although the Luso-American population is considered more permanently situated in the US compared to Portuguese communities in Northern Europe who describe their emigrant lives as "temporary,"[50] many of New Jersey's Portuguese return regularly to their birthplace and dream of Iberian retirements. Over one third of the Luso-Americans interviewed for the Ironbound Oral History Project reported visiting Portugal annually. Many in this group still maintained family homes or newly purchased apartments in Portugal. *Retornados*—those who emigrated to Lusophone Africa and were forced to return to Portugal after *25 de Abril*, later moving to the US—comprised the population that returned to Portugal least frequently. Among the second generation Luso-Americans, all had been to Portugal at least once and some returned annually with their parents or alone to visit grandparents.[51]

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[47] Fernando Santos, "Censo 2000 dá mais 9 mil pessoas às comunidades portuguesas de NJ," *Luso-Americano* (29 May 2002), 4.

[48] Arjun Appadurai, *Modernity at Large: Cultural Dimensions of Globalization* (Minneapolis: University of Minnesota Press, 1996).

[49] Arjun Appadurai, "Topographies of the Self: Praise and Emotion in Hindu India," in Catherine A. Lutz and Lila Abu-Lughod, eds., *Language and Politics of Emotion* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 1990).

[50] Klimt, "Temporary and Permanent Lives."

[51] Two of the second generation interviewees had even moved back to Portugal for junior highschool due to their parents' fear of violence in Newark area schools, only to return to the US later after the parents had changed their minds.

According to the *rancho* performers I interviewed, returning to Portugal contributes significantly to the health and maintenance of the folklore group. As Joe Cerqueira describes,

> The costumes of all of New Jersey's *ranchos* come from Portugal, all of the *ranchos* that exist today got their costumes in Portugal. The only *rancho* that didn't buy their clothes there was Barcuense in 1977—but the *ranchos* today—all clothes, all pieces of the costumes, as well as the musical instruments came from Portugal.[52]

In addition to the regular purchase and restoration of costumes, props and musical instruments, *rancho* members also report returning to Portugal for repertoire acquisition. Tony Cardoso, Director of *'Sonhos de Portugal'* describes how they acquired the song *"Vida de Emigrante"* (Emigrant's Life).

> TC: One of the musicians we had in our group is now back in Portugal for good. But before he moved back he brought us that music ... it's been one of our favorite dances.
> KDH: So he wrote the music?
> TC: He didn't write the music. He used to perform with a group in Portugal and it was one of the people in that group that taught him the music. The dance was also given to us too by, Toto was his name. It was very difficult in the beginning to learn it, but we picked it up.[53]

That Cardoso's Luso-American *rancho* was given a song about emigration by a folklore troupe in Portugal illustrates how transnational interchange truly dominates the experience of most *ranchos* in Northern New Jersey and the way in which sending and receiving contexts become "a single arena of social action."[54] Portuguese *ranchos* sing about emigration and American *ranchos* sing about Portugal. The double utopia described by Feldman-Bianco and Huse[55] resonates in this example.

Folklore dance in New Jersey is also a way for Portuguese-born parents to instill distinctly Portuguese moral values in their second and third generation "American" children and grandchildren. Folklore dance encourages the maintenance of conservative moral values such as monogamy, respect for authority and celebration

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[52] Interview with Joseph Cerqueira, tape recorded by author. Kearny, New Jersey, 18 December 2003.

[53] Interview with Joseph Cardoso.

[54] Margolis, *Little Brazil*, 29.

[55] Bela Feldman-Bianco and Donna Huse, "The Construction of Immigrant Identity," in Marsha McCabe and Tony D. Tomas, eds., *Portuguese Spinner: An American Story* (New Bedford, MA: Spinner Publications, 1998), 60-73.

of an agrarian lifestyle abandoned by immigrants who moved from Portuguese rurality to US industrial urbanism throughout the 1960s, 1970s and 1980s.[56]

Paired dancers in New Jersey *ranchos* tend to be second generation immigrants chosen by the *rancho* directors in consideration of uniform height, skill, and age. However, another factor, not often verbalized, influences the constitution of pairs—that is, many dancer pairs court each other.[57] Public courtship in Portuguese immigrant families is a charged issue. Many second generation Luso-Americans interviewed for the Rutgers-Newark Ironbound Oral History Project describe being subject to strict parenting and disciplined guidelines for dating: children should ideally choose a Portuguese-American partner.[58] Once a partner is chosen and courtship becomes public, children should stay with this partner, preferably until marriage.[59]

Luso-American college-age students also describe strict parental monitoring of courtship, especially for daughters. Dating in the presence of adult family members, acquaintances, or at the very least other peers, is preferable to going out on a date alone. Given these guidelines, dancerly participation in *ranchos folclóricos* increases the chances of finding a Portuguese mate.[60] Jessica Moreira, a nineteen-year-old dancer in the *'Danças e Cantares de Portugal' rancho*, describes the courtship of couples in her group and the familial pressures she feels to find a Portuguese mate:

> JM: Well actually one of them, the girl, was dancing and then I guess they started going out and she brought her boyfriend to the group so they could stay as partners. And then another couple, they've been [*rancho*] partners since they were five. They started in the *Rancho Infantil* and they've been partners for ten years now. She's twenty and he's eighteen, and they started going out about a year ago.
> KDH: Would you say it's important to your parents that you date a Portuguese guy?
> JM: Yes
> KDH: Why?

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[56] João Carvalho suggests that *rancho* song texts "express the patterns of behavior the community wishes to perpetuate. These are childraising, obedience to parents, courtship strategies ..." (João Soeiro de Carvalho, "Ranchos Folclóricos: A Strategy for Identification Among Portuguese Migrants in New Jersey," Unpublished Master's Thesis, Columbia University [1990], 39). I wish to argue that, in addition, the embodied **process** of performing in a *rancho* ensures cultural reproduction of "Portuguese" moral values.

[57] Carvalho, "Ranchos Folclóricos," 30.

[58] Many interviewees described a curious duality in the discipline their parents employed. In the US household rules for socializing were much more restrictive than they were when the families traveled to Portugal for the summer.

[59] Public courtship can mean bringing the boyfriend/girlfriend to family functions and being seen with this partner in "public" (within the Portuguese community).

[60] Carvalho, "Ranchos Folclóricos."

> JM: I don't know, my father thinks the Portuguese are better than everything else, he just regards us as way up there, I guess cuz he's in ... construction, the Portuguese just kind of strive a little more and he sees *os outros* [the others] as *preguiçosos* [lazy].
> KDH: Do you think the *rancho* is a way to ensure that you ...
> JM: Even if he doesn't say it directly, I know he wants me to go out with a Portuguese guy ... The *rancho* is to keep myself involved, to keep myself going, keep the culture going.[61]

Jessica is involved in many other Portuguese activities at the Portuguese Instructive Social Club of Elizabeth and attended Portuguese language school for eight years before college. Although Jessica's father conveyed his wish that his daughter find a Portuguese husband through arguments concerning Portuguese industriousness, other second-generation teenagers cite language as the primary reason for wanting a Portuguese mate. Sónia DaCosta, interviewed for the Ironbound Oral History Project, states that marrying outside the Portuguese community would cause problems in her extended family. "I want my husband to be able to talk to my parents and grandparents," she says.[62] Folklore performance not only "keeps the culture going" among younger generations through the rehearsal of Portuguese songs and dances, it also "keeps the culture going" by fostering Luso-American friendships and endogamous pairing. Dancing folklore also facilitates adult supervision of public courtship and exerts social pressure on couples to maintain their relationships and work toward marriage.

In addition to promoting endogamous courtship practices, *ranchos folclóricos* also instill in second generation dancers a respect for their rural heritage and the traditional gender roles that come with it. *Ranchos* both in the US and in Portugal reconstitute popular songs and dances created by a nameless and faceless collective of peasants at the turn of the nineteenth and twentieth centuries. Rurality, seen from the vantage point of Portuguese immigrants living in Northeastern US cities, becomes a utopian space.[63] *Rancho* songs and dances hearken back to a static, fictionalized past, where social hierarchies are unquestioned and rural life is stripped of the backbreaking labor and economic impoverishment that often characterized the quotidian life of agrarian workers. *Rancho* dancers carry onto the stage agricultural tools long obsolete, in a material celebration of peasant lifestyle. These "objects of ethnography," in Barbara Kirshenblatt-Gimblett's sense of the term,[64] are stripped of their utility, framed as aesthetic mementos or theatrical props.

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[61] Interview with Jessica Moreira, tape recorded by author. Newark, NJ, 15 December 2003. My parenthesis, code switching in original.

[62] Interview with Sónia DaCosta, tape recorded by Maria DaSilva. Rutgers-Newark Oral History of the Ironbound Project (Kearny, New Jersey, 16 April 2001).

[63] Feldman-Bianco and Huse, "The Construction of Immigrant Identity."

[64] Barbara Kirshenblatt-Gimblett, "Objects of Ethnography," in Ivan Karp and Steven D. Levine, eds., *Exhibiting Cultures: The Poetics and Politics of Museum Display* (Washington DC: Smithsonian Institute Press, 1991), 386-443.

Through song lyrics that remember bucolic courtship and camaraderie and choreography that has dancers, arms akimbo, whirling around and around in dizzying reveries, *ranchos folclóricos* invoke rural life in its most idealized form.

Many New Jersey *rancho* members come from families of Portugal's rural North,[65] and *rancho* dancing promotes an embodied, albeit "invented,"[66] celebration of this ancestral past. Jessica Moreira, for example, describes a float that members of her Portuguese Youth Group—many of them second generation *rancho* dancers—constructed for the Portugal Day Parade. In the float, Portugal's regions were each represented by a pair of Luso-American teenagers dressed as Portuguese peasant archetypes. The couples were further identified through the props characteristic of rural life according to region.

> We had Minho represented with the brick stove. We had the smoke machine inside so it was smoking the *chouriços* (smoked sausage), it looked so pretty ... And of course for Minho we had the girl and the guy dressed in *rancho* outfits. And then we had Trás-os-Montes represented with a *carro de mão* (wheelbarrow) made out of wood with hay on it ... and we had Nazaré with a fish net with dried fish ... and we had a girl with the *sete saias* (seven skirts) and a *peixeiro* (fisherman). Do you know the story of the *sete saias*? I'm such a dork, I know all this stuff. Well, the *peixeiras* (fishmongers) in Nazaré have *sete saias* because the *peixeiros*—their husbands—used to go out to sea for seven months and every month they used to take off a *saia* and then when they were at their last *saia*, they know their husbands are coming home.[67]

The float thus celebrated rural life in all of its regional diversity while also embodying idealized patterns of conservative sociability. The story of the *sete saias* is a powerful illustration of this—the wife waiting patiently (and chastely) for her husband, shedding one skirt at a time, invoking her body as a calendar to mark the husband's return. According to the *sete saias* sequencing, it is only the husband who will enjoy the *peixeira*'s full state of undress.

'Não é para ti' (It is not for you), a dance frequently performed by *'Sonhos de Portugal'* further exhibits female chastity. Throughout the choreography, young male dancers try to kiss their female partners and are snubbed with the dramatic wag of an index finger and a kerchiefed shooing. Dressed in long skirts and aprons, female *rancho* dancers role-play traditional constructs of rural femininity.[68] Male

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[65] Carvalho, "Ranchos Folclóricos," 12.

[66] Eric Hobsbawm and Terrance Ranger, eds., *The Invention of Tradition* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 1983).

[67] Interview with Jessica Moreira, parenthesis mine, code switching in original.

[68] This practice cites a fictional "pseudo past," an idealized construct; for, as many anthropologists note, nineteenth- and twentieth-century women, particularly in the North of Portugal, often performed heavy agrarian labor, while men went off to war or in search of work. See Caroline Brettell, *Men Who Migrate, Women Who Wait: Population and History in a Portuguese Parish* (Princeton: Princeton

dancers, typically dressed in long pants and vests, adroitly guide their female partners through *viras*, strong hands placed firmly on the small of their partners' backs in a symbolic display of masculine power and leadership. In many *viras* the men and women dance in pairs in single broad circle. Individuals occasionally break off and dance with other partners or form smaller foursomes of men and women circling rapidly in quadrants of autonomous unpaired movements. These "dancerly breeches," however, are always followed by the resumption of male/female pairing and a return to the permanent partnerships where boyfriends and girlfriends end up in the proper pre-marital embrace. *Rancho* costumes and choreography present an anachronistic portrait of traditional gender roles, flying in the face of the high incidence of female industrial labor and increasing rates of university study among Portuguese immigrant women living in the United States.[69] *Rancho* dancing embodies a world of conservative moral values, traditional gender roles, and the celebration of rural ancestry despite the urban relocation and concomitant liberalizing forces faced by many Portuguese immigrants living in the northeastern United States.

In addition to catalyzing ties to Portugal and solidifying Portuguese ethnic identity, *rancho* dancing also becomes a vehicle to demonstrate assimilation and social prestige within the US. Many immigrants experience a double-edged lack of prestige. In the northeastern US many Portuguese immigrants are blue-collar workers who have shown, until very recently, little socio-economic mobility. In Portugal, emigrants who return home for summer vacation or retirement are often ostracized as uncultured *nouveaux riches* who return from years of US labor speaking neither Portuguese nor English well, with a bent toward conspicuous consumption.[70] According to many immigrant *rancho* members, performing folklore helps mitigate this stereotype of Portuguese emigrants, boosting their status, both within the Luso-American community and in Portugal. As one dancer explained,

> We are not rude people who went away only to make money, as most people might think; we are able to cultivate forms of traditional music and dance even better than *ranchos* in Portugal. *Ranchos folclóricos* are evidence that migrants have culture.[71]

University Press, 1986).

[69] Many immigration historians document high rates of female industrial labor. See Donald Reed Taft, *Two Portuguese Communities in New England* (Boston: Ayer Company Pub., 1969). A recent study of immigration between 1960 and 1980 documents a surprising trend where university attendance is higher for Luso-American women than it is for Luso-American men. See Maria da Glória Mulcahy, "The Portuguese in the US: An Overview," Invited paper given at the "Race, Culture, Nation: Arguments Across the Portuguese Speaking World" Conference at Brown University and University of Massachusetts-Dartmouth (March 2001).

[70] Cole, *Women of the Praia*; Brettell, *Anthropology and Migration*.

[71] Quoted in Carvalho, "Ranchos Folclóricos."

Dancing in a Portuguese *rancho*, according to Rutgers Newark college student Brian Santos, raised his social standing within a New Jersey public high school. Brian, who dances in the *rancho 'Sonhos de Portugal'* recalls a performance that took place in Kearny, New Jersey.

> My friends in high school were always really interested in it. There's an international festival every year at the highschool and when I was a student there, we performed. Basically, it is one day dedicated to all the different cultures represented in the school, and there are different performances from different cultures and the Portuguese is always one of the most popular. We always got standing ovations, everyone always loved it, the teachers, the students, they would always call us on stage and ask us lots of questions.[72]

Brian's testimony shows the effects of the 1974 Ethnic Heritage Act which encourages multicultural celebration, even at the high school level and where, particularly in a diverse region like Northern New Jersey, children of emigrants raise their social capital by performing ethnic difference in a public context. Brian explains that, contrary to some of the kids in Portugal who get teased by their peers for performing in *ranchos*, dancing folklore is seen as "cool" by many of his New Jersey friends, Portuguese and non-Portuguese alike. His family is also very supportive of his participation in folklore because "It shows that I am involved in our culture."[73] Brian, then, garners concentric circles of social kudos by dancing folklore, starting with the most intimate social context, that of the nuclear family, and radiating out into larger rings of friends, neighbors, classmates, teachers and administrators. Brian even articulates the stature of his *rancho* within a national framework:

> We actually are considered professionals, we're in the *Hudson County Book of Professional Entertainers*, so anyone who is looking for a certain musical group can find us there. You know we're also in the Library of Congress, in Washington DC. We're documented in there![74]

Rancho director Tony Cardoso echoes this story of broad recognition and visibility:

> We've danced at the Statue of Liberty ... we were even invited to perform at Giants Stadium ... We've also been on Portuguese TV and even the American FOX channel, you know FOX 5 ... it was really something for the kids to be on a major channel, to be on national TV.[75]

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[72] Interview with Brian Santos, tape recorded by author. Kearny, New Jersey, 19 May 2002.

[73] Interview with Brian Santos.

[74] Interview with Brian Santos.

[75] Interview with Tony Cardoso.

In addition to celebrating ethnic difference and catalyzing social prestige and visibility, *rancho* performance is also intimately linked to Luso-American commercial success and emergent political power in Northern New Jersey. Many *ranchos* are officially tied to cultural organizations. *'Sonhos do Portugal'* and *'Os Sonhos Continuam'*, for example, are affiliated with the *Associação Cultural Portuguesa* in Kearny, NJ. *'Danças e Cantares de Portugal'* is affiliated with the Portuguese Instructive Social Club in Elizabeth, New Jersey. The *'Rancho Folclórico da Casa do Minho'* is affiliated with the *Casa do Minho* in Newark. Some groups, however, are also officially or unofficially linked to prominent Luso-American merchants and entrepreneurs. The *rancho 'Eira'*, for example, is linked to Bernardino Coutinho, owner of the Coutinho Bakery chain and founder of the Portugal Day parade. *'Sonhos de Portugal'* and *'Os Sonhos Continuam'* are linked to Licínio Cruz, a former district judge and co-owner of the successful Cruz Construction company.

Links to prominent community leaders can mean a variety of advantages for *ranchos* in Northern New Jersey. Tony Cardoso emphasizes the financial and logistical support his *rancho* has received from Cruz Construction.

> Cruz over the years has supported the group with money and outfits at times ... Every year they make a contribution when it comes to Portugal Day in Newark. They not only give the truck trailer to the group, they also supply the wood every single year ... to build it, to supply the wood, which is a couple thousand dollars, and another couple thousand for other materials. [The float] takes about three days to assemble.[76]

The bond between Cruz Construction and *'Sonhos de Portugal'* is fortified and made visible not only during the enormous Portugal Day Parade,[77] but also through annual performances at the company picnic and other business functions sponsored by Cruz Construction. Similar to the commercial *padrinhos* Portuguese *ranchos* cultivate, New Jersey *ranchos* often share personnel with their corporate sponsor. Tony Cardoso, for example, has worked for Cruz Construction for decades. He sees his role in the *rancho* and in the company as symbiotic and mutually constitutive. Cruz construction not only lends *'Sonhos de Portugal'* financial assistance, but also the social cachet that comes with being linked to a successful Portuguese-American enterprise. *'Sonhos de Portugal'*, in turn, symbolically enacts the company's commit-

[76] Interview with Tony Cardoso.

[77] The Portugal Day Parade in Newark, organized each year by Bernardino Coutinho and his son Alberto has exploded in popularity. What started on June 10, 1980 as a one day event to "unify the Portuguese community" on the anniversary of Luis de Camões' death has ballooned into a week long event with an operating budget of $600,000 and a total spectatorship of well over half a million people. See Interview with Bernardino Coutinho and Alberto Coutinho, tape recorded by Vanessa Marie Monteiro, Rutgers-Newark Oral History of the Ironbound Project, Newark, New Jersey (14 October 2002).

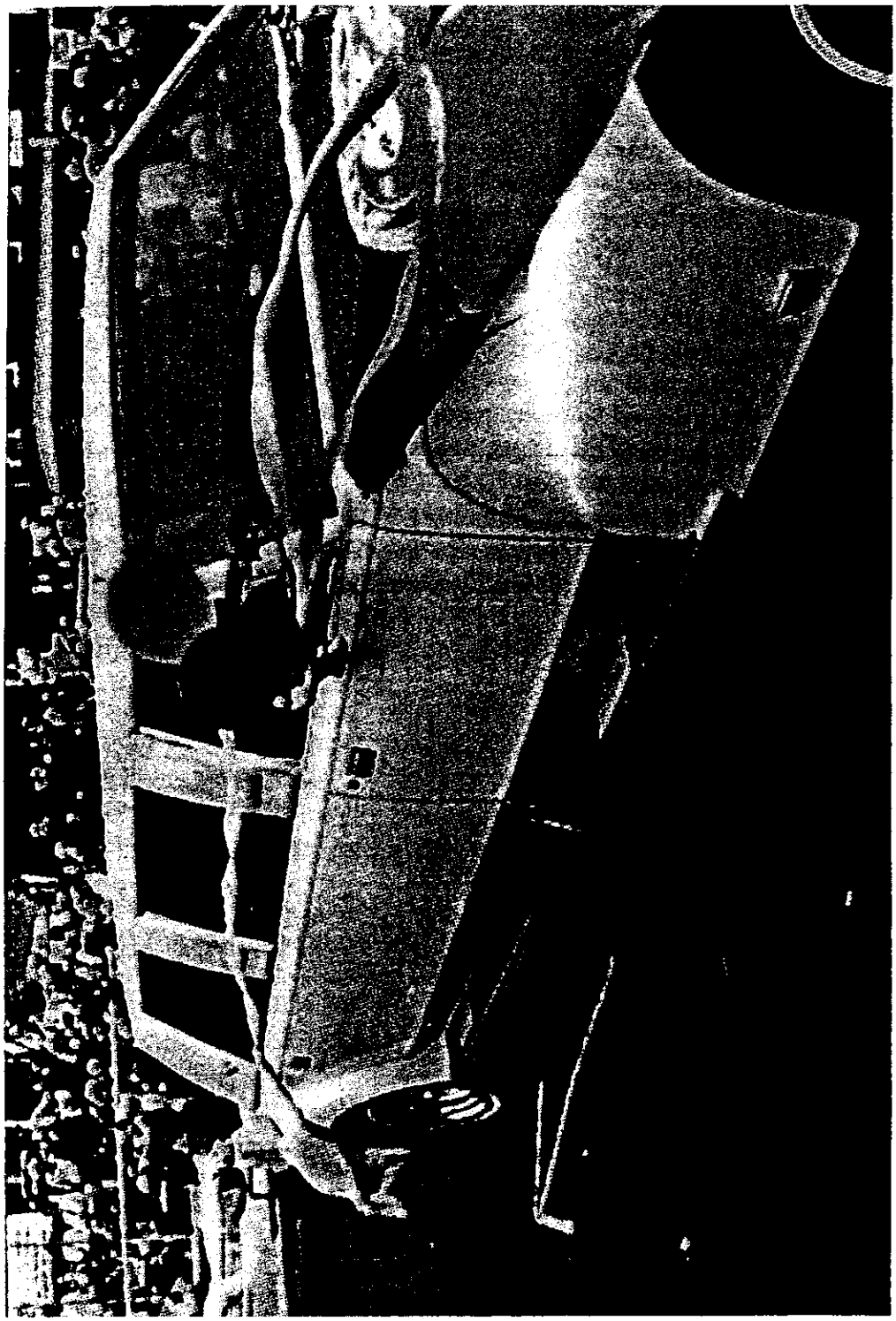

Figure 5. Limousine Draped With Portuguese Flag, Portugal Day Celebrations (Ferry Street) (Courtesy Coutinho Foundation).

ment to Portugal and to its Luso-American employees through the performance of nineteenth century popular traditions—traditions that help an emigrant workforce cohere overseas while advertising the company's services and ethnic provenance.

Ranchos folclóricos play with mnemonic function—calling up memories of summer *festas* in the North of Portugal for Portuguese emigrants far from home.[78] At the same time *ranchos* help a community in diaspora, caught up in the liminal moment of performance, forget their current geographic circumstance and find themselves transported back in time and space, as if reversing emigration. *Ranchos* in an emigrant context encourage both mnemonic recall and erasure. However, bonds between Luso-American entrepreneurship and folklore performance add a charged symbolic layer to collective memory not present in the Portuguese context. *Rancho* performers, barefoot on stage holding hoes and pitchforks, exist in marked contrast to their corporate *padrinhos*, successful navigators of America's industrial Northeast and exemplary portraits of the American Dream attained. *Ranchos* in this context become a measuring stick for the success of the emigration project—an initiative often fueled by the desire to leave the plight of agrarian poverty for a place that promises industrial opportunity and social mobility. The staged celebration of rural life, a misty unreality, exists in metonymic tension with the figure of New Jersey's Luso-American entrepreneurs, dressed in three piece suits and driving expensive cars, their economic rise often the product of successful urban businesses.

The symbolic tension created by the relationship between *ranchos folclóricos* and their commercial sponsors is nowhere better illustrated than in the Portugal Day parade where barefoot dancers in peasant garb march alongside sleek white limousines (see Figure 5), marking both experiential distance and emotional proximity between rural past and urban present, in a complex homage to two national contexts.

In addition to intimate ties to emigrant entrepreneurship, *rancho* performance has been a consistent presence at celebrations of Luso-Americans' rise to political power in New Jersey. There has been much ink spilled in the attempt to document and to theorize the historic lack of political participation among the Portuguese in the United States.[79] Casual debates on the topic often arrive at the same conclusion; voting is not part of the Portuguese culture, given the fascist government that had stifled political agency from 1926 to 1974. However, as Onésimo Almeida rightly points out, lack of political participation throughout Portuguese emigrant

[78] Joseph Cerqueira, Interview by author, Kearny, New Jersey, 23 October 2002.

[79] Onésimo T. Almeida, "The Portuguese-American Communities and Politics: A Look at the Cultural Roots of a Distant Relationship," *Gávea-Brown* 19/20 (1999): 229-43; Clyde Barrow, ed., *Portuguese-Americans and Contemporary Civic Culture in Massachusetts* (Dartmouth, MA: Center for Portuguese Studies, University of Massachusetts-Dartmouth, 2002); Rita Duarte Marinho and Elmer E. Cornwell, *Os Luso-Americanos no processo político americano: estudo duma situação concreta* (Angra do Heroismo: Gabinete de Emigração e Apoio às Açorianas 1992); Rita Moniz, "The Portuguese of New Bedford, Massachusetts and Providence Rhode Island: A Comparative Microanalysis of Political Attitudes and Behavior," PhD Dissertation, Brown University (1979).

communities predates the installation of the *Estado Novo*.[80] As recently as 1996, the authors of a proposed documentary entitled "Newark's Silent Majority: Citizens Without a Voice" describe the situation in the Ironbound:

> More than fifty years ago they started coming, drawn by the hope of a promising future in a bountiful country. Today they find themselves possessing the material things the country offered, but missing the joy and power of a people who govern themselves. Newark's Portuguese-Americans don't vote ... They have turned the Ironbound into an inner city paradise, but have never elected one of their own to the City Council. And they are bitter about it. The Ironbound is a dumping ground and its people whipping boys for cynical politicians who revel in Luso-American political impotence, never failing to ignore it.[81]

Lancellotti and Gardner's depiction of Newark's Portuguese in 1996, however, no longer reflects the reality of the community in 2004. Much has changed since the late 1990s. The Portuguese government installed a new and improved Portuguese Consulate in a prestigious building on the outskirts of the Ironbound in 1998. Official ribbon-cuttings attended by the Portuguese Prime Minister and Luso-American leaders became the forum for a revitalized campaign aimed at increasing political participation among Luso-Americans. In November 1998, Augusto Amador became the first Portuguese-American councilman elected to office in the history of Newark. And in May 2002, with the election of Governor James McGreevey, Dina Matos McGreevey, a Portuguese-American citizen, became New Jersey's First Lady. The Portuguese government even recognized this change during a 2003 "Seminar on Participation and Citizenship" in Lisbon, citing the increase in Luso-Americans elected to political office as a model upswing in civic engagement.[82]

Since the late 1990s, as Newark's Luso-Americans have raised their political visibility, and received increased attention from the Portuguese government,[83] *ranchos folclóricos* have served as the expressive exemplar of Portuguese ethnicity in action. Many of New Jersey's twelve *ranchos* have performed at voter drives, election parties and alongside campaign speeches. In fact, in May 2002, newly elected New Jersey governor James McGreevey hosted a party on the lawn of the governor's mansion in celebration of Portugal Day, marked by the performances of three Newark *ranchos*. Reviews and color photographs of these *rancho*

[80] Almeida, "The Portuguese-American Communities and Politics."

[81] John Lancellotti and Janet Gardner, quoted in Almeida, "The Portuguese-American Communities and Politics," 232-33.

[82] Martins da Cruz, "Quer Luso-descendentes mais envolvidas na vida cívica e política," *Luso-Americano* (30 April 2003), 9.

[83] Paulo Pocinho, Cônsul Geral de Portugal, taperecorded interview with author, Newark, NJ (26 February 2003).

performances made their way into the mainstream local press, as well as the Lusophone mediascape, announcing, in the words of several journalists, the political arrival of the Portuguese.[84] In 2003 Portugal Day was again celebrated at the Governor's mansion—this time the featured entertainment comprised the *ranchos 'Os Sonhos de Portugal'* and *'Os Sonhos Continuam'*. In addition to the rapid-fire footwork of the *rancho* dancers, which commanded rapt attention from the large crowd of Portuguese-Americans, there was an additional costumed dancer who captured the public's fancy. Teetering on the edge of the performance space, dressed from head to toe in a tiny embroidered *rancho* costume the color of the Portuguese flag, was two-year-old Jacqueline McGreevey, the daughter of New Jersey's Irish-American governor and his Portuguese-American wife. As the diminutive figure clapped her hands in time to the accordion's animated melody, raising her arms in emulation of the other second-generation dancers, the connection between Portuguese folklore and US politics took on an almost poetic resonance. As the Portuguese government reminds any Luso-descendant who will listen, "[politics] and the preservation of cultural roots are not incompatible."

Conclusion

In summary, *rancho* dancing enculturates a new generation of Portuguese-Americans according to the moral values of their parents' homeland. Second generation Luso-Americans perform romanticized choreographies of rural life, where their parents' experience of back-breaking agricultural labor and poverty in Northern Portugal is smoothed over. Through the execution of paired dance steps, the vocalization of popular song lyrics, and the adherence to contemporary rehearsal practices, folklore dancing models conservative behavior such as the maintenance of traditional gender roles, respect for authority, and monogamy. Folklore dancing also provides children of emigrants with a pool of endogamous courtship possibilities, while affording informal adult supervision of weekend social activities. Second generation Luso-American dancers make a visible commitment to their ethnic heritage through folklore performance, which in turn grants them positive social reinforcement in family, school and neighborhood contexts.

Revivalist folklore performance ties into US immigration ideologies. As a result of legislation such as the 1965 repeal of the National Quota Act, the passage of the 1974 Ethnic Heritage Act, and the general valorization of post civil rights era multiculturalism, the United States has witnessed a proliferation of "ethnic celebrations, a zeal for genealogy, increased travel to ancestral homelands, and greater interest in ethnic artifacts, cuisine, music, literature and, of course, language."[85] *Rancho* dancing participates in this trend, revealing New Jersey's

[84] See, for example, "A Drumthwacket foi sábado 'Uma casa portuguesa, com certeza,'" *Luso-Americano* (5 June 2002): 8.

[85] Marylin Halter, *Shopping for Identity: The Marketing of Ethnicity* (New York: Schocken Books, 2000), 5.

Portuguese population as, "exotics at home, hidden in plain sight,"[86] part of the state's ethnic diversity that local officials work to promote. Through the celebration of its ethnic neighborhoods and multicultural arts programming in municipal parks and the New Jersey Performing Arts Center, Newark has pinned much of its hopes for urban revitalization on the "marketing of ethnic heritage," a late twentieth-century North American phenomenon that anthropologists are increasingly theorizing as part and parcel of American modernity.[87] Portuguese *rancho* performance, a consistent presence at "Diversity Day" festivals on New Jersey college and secondary school campuses, Newark's Portugal Day parade, and other US folklore festivals, plays into both municipal and federal ideologies of ethnic celebration and inclusivity.

Changes in Portuguese state emigration ideology also undergird the development of *ranchos folclóricos* in diaspora. Once seen as traitors to their homeland, Portuguese emigrants are now the object of increasing state support and attention. In numerous high profile visits to Newark over the past ten years, Portugal's political leaders have urged Luso-Americans to fortify ties to their homeland while becoming actively engaged in America's political and civic life. Both private and public institutions in Portugal have sponsored initiatives that aim to affect this hybrid policy; US Naturalization campaigns are funded alongside Portuguese language schools throughout emigrant communities in the US. Northern New Jersey's second generation Luso-Americans have been marked by this two pronged policy, practicing what Rumbaut and Portes term "selective acculturation." Along the lines of Rumbaut and Portes' definition, Luso-Americans in Newark exhibit a high rate of bilingualism in the second generation, balancing assimilation into mainstream American society with the retention of core values and cultural practices from their parents native context. Given New Jersey *ranchos'* relationship to Luso-American entrepreneurs and campaigns for US political participation, revivalist folklore in diaspora reflects Portugal's emigration ideology. *Rancho* performers enact a commitment to their ancestral home through the restoration and dissemination of Portuguese tradition in the diaspora while celebrating the success of the emigration project through association with Luso-American business leaders and their growing political clout within a US context.

Rancho dancing participates in a chain link of lusophone media production and consumption which strengthens and perpetuates the vitality of the Portuguese language and of Portuguese expressive culture, catalyzing communities of sentiment around the globe that can imagine themselves as an ethnic collective despite geographical distance. New Jersey *rancho* members make use of new televisual, communications and information technologies in order to amass repertoires, research fellow *ranchos* and promote their own performance agendas across

[86] Micaela di Leonardo, *Exotics at Home: Anthropologists, Others, America Modernity* (Chicago: University of Chicago Press, 1998).

[87] Di Leonardo, *Exotics at Home*; Halter, *Shopping for Identity*.

national and continental borders. Seeking to repair instruments, purchase costumes and videotape live performances, New Jersey *rancho* scouts and aficionados travel to Portugal regularly, ensuring a constant transatlantic traffic in goods, services and people related to the thriving revivalist folklore "industry." Folklore performance links Portugal and the United States on myriad levels, offering transmigrants a way to process national, lingual and cultural plurality through the lens of expressive tradition.